

GitHub now most popular open source forge

According to the latest numbers from Stephen O'Grady of the technology analyst firm Redmonk and open source specialists Black Duck Software, the less than charmingly named GitHub has surpassed Google Code, SourceForge and Microsoft's CodePlex to become the most popular open source software forge. The findings were released in a June 2 webinar titled *Survival of the Forges*, after examining the total number of commits from January through May 2011. GitHub had over a million commits (1,153,059) followed by SourceForge (624,989), Google Code (287,901) and CodePlex (49,839).

"Despite GitHub's age (we turned 3 in April), our service has become the dominant platform from which developers and companies choose to host and share their code (and we have every intention of making sure it stays that way," P J Hyett, the firm's chief, mentioned in a post on the GitHub blog.

According to O'Grady of RedMonk, the data was pulled from 2.1 million commits made in four big open source forges (CodePlex, GitHub, Google Code, and SourceForge) from January to May of this year. "As important as the languages developers are choosing is how they leverage them, which in turn is a function of where they host it. Our belief is that GitHub is emerging as a massive centre of gravity. This is, in our view, primarily attributable to the social coding approach advocated for and supported by GitHub. Based on the decentralised version control system Git, which makes branching and thereby forking sufficiently low overhead to incent the behaviour [coverage], GitHub has changed the way that software is built in public, and attracted substantial attention as a result," O'Grady wrote in a blog post.

O'Grady also talked about the correlation between the developer language used and forges used to host project commits.

The most popular language on the GitHub code forge is Ruby, which appears at the bottom of the lists for both Sourceforge and Google Code, and in fifth place at CodePlex. C++ takes the top spot at Sourceforge, Java is the victor among Google Coders, while C# is going down like a (fairly weak) storm at Codeplex.

Take a look at the most popular languages:

1. C++ (362,077 commits)
2. Java (335,992 commits)
3. Python (296,896 commits)
4. C (264,468 commits)
5. JavaScript (251,557 commits)
6. Ruby (234,980 commits)
7. PHP (154,250 commits)
8. C# (125,848 commits)
9. Perl (89,720 commits)

Originally founded by Chris Wanstrath, P J Hyett and Tom Preston-Werner as a project to simplify sharing code, GitHub is a Web-based hosting service for software development projects that use the Git revision control system. It is written using Ruby on Rails and offers both commercial plans and free accounts for open source projects.

World's first Chrome laptop goes on sale

Beating tech majors Samsung and Acer, Australian manufacturer Kogan has launched



the world's first laptop running Google's Chrome OS. The company will start shipping the device starting 7 June 2011. The Agora laptop features a 1.3 MP webcam and 1.3 GHz Celeron M ULV (ultra-low voltage) CPU and 1GB of DDR2 RAM in the basic version, upgradeable to 4GB.

"While Chromium is still in its early stages, we know the operating system is innovative technology which represents the future of computing," Ruslan Kogan, chief executive of the laptop maker, said in a statement. "It may take some getting used to for some to operate entirely in the cloud, but the massive benefits for the end user are driving acceptance of entirely Web-based services," he added.

Toshiba to come up with Android-based 'Thrive'

Foraying into the tablet market, Toshiba Corp will soon launch its tablet named 'Thrive'. The device measures 25.4-cm (10-inch) in size and runs on Android's Honeycomb platform.



It will go on sale in the United States on July 10, 2011. Starting at \$429, it is primarily aimed at consumers who use tablets at home, said Jeff Barney, general manager of digital products, Toshiba America.